

CUSTOMER SERVICE Pocketbook

3rd Edition

A pocketful of tools, tips and techniques for everyone who contributes, directly or indirectly, to ensuring that the customer comes first

Sean McManus
& Tony Newby



THE CUSTOMER SERVICE POCKETBOOK

By Tony Newby & Sean McManus

Drawings by Phil Hailstone

Comments on the 1st edition

"Down to earth practical guide ... what I would expect from your work with us on Customer Service. It removes a lot of the mystique and concentrates on the real issues."

Mr. L.J.G. Purdie, Chief Pensions Manager, Scottish Widows.

Comments on the 2nd edition

"We will certainly continue to use the pocketbook with all our new starters. It really helps to make people realise that everyone has customers, and that internal customers are also important."

Carolyn Whitesmith, Training Controller, Avon Insurance plc.



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Customer is King!



WHY CUSTOMER SERVICE MATTERS

WHY CUSTOMER SERVICE MATTERS



CUSTOMER CONTACT

Customer service matters because **everybody** in **every** organisation:

- Either helps customers **directly**
- Or helps colleagues (**internal customers**) who serve the paying customer

This book is for people who work in:

- Commercial companies supplying goods or services
- Public sector utilities
- Central and local government departments
- Voluntary organisations

... because they **all** have customers.

WHY CUSTOMER SERVICE MATTERS

YOUR PERSONAL NEEDS



The benefits to you personally of delivering good customer service to your colleagues and external customers are:

- You'll get more satisfaction at work, knowing that others enjoy dealing with you and respect you and your work
- Others will be friendly towards you, and will be more understanding of occasional problems and willing to help
- You'll have less re-work if you get it right first time
- So you'll waste less time *fire-fighting* problems
- And will have more control of your time and workload



WHY CUSTOMER SERVICE MATTERS

ORGANISATION NEEDS



Businesses and non-profit organisations need:

- **Sustainable competitive advantage:** rival businesses might easily match your prices or products, but will find it harder to infuse the business with an outstanding customer service ethic
- **To be profitable:** good customer service frees the company from the downward spiral of competing on price because people will pay more for great service
- **A productive, stress-free work environment:** great customer service means happier customers, happier team members and less conflict at work
- **Cost-efficiency:** satisfying customers first time means less money is wasted taking complaints and correcting mistakes – particularly important in public sector organisations where there is no obvious profit to track, but there can be a lot of hidden wastage
- **A good reputation:** important for attracting future customers and investors, and essential for the credibility of non-profit organisations

WHY CUSTOMER SERVICE MATTERS

THE IMPORTANCE OF *HOW*



Today **how** you deliver your products and services is as important as **what** they are.

Competing goods and services don't differ greatly from each other, so customers will choose where to shop based on the service they get.

Before they consider spending any money, customers will already know whether they trust you and like you. They will have judged what you look like, what you sound like and how responsive you are. They will have seen how you treat other customers.

Often customers can only judge quality based on the service they get. How can a patient judge a doctor's competence, or a litigant assess the skills of their legal counsel? How can a novice tell whether a computer is right for them? They all depend on a service that inspires confidence and shows attention to their needs.